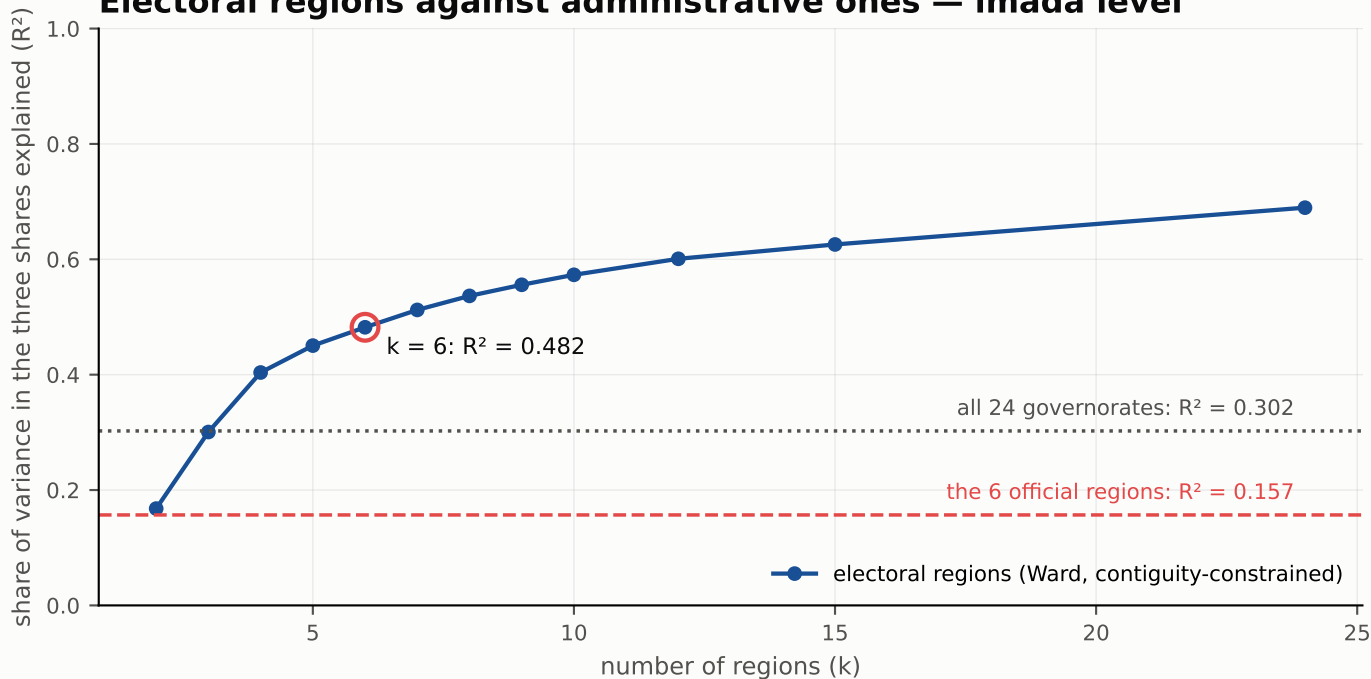


Electoral regions against administrative ones — imada level



Ward agglomeration on the three standardised shares of 2,042 imadas, constrained so every region is contiguous. The administrative lines are the same statistic computed on the official partitions of the same units, so the comparison is like for like: at $k = 6$ the clustering explains 3.1× what the official regions do, and it passes all 24 governorates at $k = 4$.

Ward maximises this criterion by construction, so the clustering is expected to win; the size of the gap is the informative part, not its sign.

Source: ISIE procès-verbaux, 9,419 certified stations · boundaries OCHA/HDX COD-AB (CC BY-IGO) · queen contiguity from shared boundary vertices